

The Introduction Paragraph

The Structure

G Grab the reader's attention:
Use a: FACT, STATISTIC, DESCRIPTION, DEFINITION, QUOTE or BACKGROUND INFORMATION

A Add an explanation of the grabber/hook

T T.A.G.-Introduce the title, author & genre

E End with the thesis statement

Follow These Steps...

* Determine and reread THE STRUCTURE of the introduction paragraph. SEE ABOVE.

1 CHOOSE A GRABBER that is going to work with the essay topic given to you. WRITE YOUR GRABBER.

2 EXPLAIN YOUR GRABBER- React or respond your grabber. Use TO EXPLAIN or TO ELABORATE.

3 INTRODUCE THE GENRE, TITLE, AUTHOR- Use this order, and begin this sentence with, "In the..."

4 AFTER YOUR T.A.G. WRITE YOUR THESIS STATEMENT:
Go back to the essay question



The Appetizer - a Menu for Writing an Essay

Choose a Grabber That Works for Your Essay
Topic & Model the Example!

1

ACRONYM: Fiona Startled Dear, Dimpled, Quiet
Baby Iggy

FACT:

Ex. According to Quantum Learning Solutions, leaders play an integral role, and the best leaders are the ones who invest their time to get to know people.

STATISTIC:

Ex. According to InfoPro Learning, "83% of organizations say it is important to develop leaders at all levels."

DESCRIBE:

Ex. There are three seconds left on the clock of the championship game. The coach walks over, puts his hand on his player's shoulder and says, "You have put your heart, mind and soul into every attempt on this field. You are an amazing player!"

DEFINE:

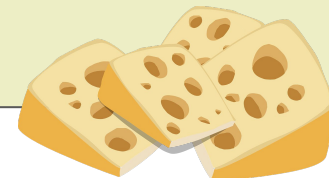
Ex. The definition of leadership is the ability to lead, show bravery in a time of need and uncertainty, and have a group trust someone to steer them in the right direction.

QUOTATION:

Ex. John Maxwell said, "A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way, and shows the way."

BACKGROUND INFORMATION:

Ex. Leadership is seen through all walks of life from coaches, to presidents, to teachers and family members. People look to leaders for inspiration, creativity, and decisions. Others look to leaders for motivation and help.



English, Oh My! ~2017

The Introduction Paragraph

Explanation of the Grabber

3

Add an Explanation of the Grabber/Hook!

1. Make sure to use one of the following transitions: To explain, ; To elaborate,
2. Explain the grabber in your own words without using the words, "I", "Me", "My" or "You".

Ex. (GRABBER) John Maxwell said, "A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way, and shows the way." (EXPLANATION) To explain, leaders will step out first, direct, show bravery while helping others. Leaders know what they should do, and they are willing to motivate and inspire others.

4

Introduce the T.A.G.

Introducing the T.A.G.

*T.A.G stands for TITLE, AUTHOR & GENRE

*Always start with

In the...

In the _____, _____, by
genre title
_____,
author

The Appetizer - a Menu for Writing an Essay



Writing the Thesis Statement

5

1. Your thesis statement comes from the **QUESTION** or **TASK**.

...Here's a trick.

- A. Take out the question stem-
how is, why is, explain, what is, etc.

Example Essay Question:

Who are two leaders who have shown leadership?

TAKE OUT QUESTION STEM: Who are two leaders who have shown leadership.

- B. Make the sentence a complete statement:
There are two leaders who have shown leadership.

6

Combine the T.A.G. & Thesis Statement

Put the T.A.G. in front your your thesis statement.

Ex. In the article, "Leaders in America", by Wilson Monroe, there are two leaders who have shown leadership.

